4. **High Transmission Loss:** Transmission loss in power distribution is almost 25 per cent in rural areas.
5. **Power Theft:** Unauthorized use and diversion of power are evil practices adopted by affluent people that hinders the rural electrification process.

10.12 Requirements for Rural Development

Slater Villages: Gilbert Slater, the first professor of economics at Madras University, published his book, Some South Indian Villages, in 1918 following a survey of some villages like Vadamalaipuram (Ramnad), Gangaikondan (Tirunelveli), Palakkuurichi (Tanjore) and Dusi (North Arcot) in Tamil Nadu by his students. It was subsequently done by different groups of researchers in the 1930s, 1950s, 1960s, and two of the villages only in the early 21st century. The resurveys became an important historical record. They provided a baseline for several later revisits to his villages, and have inspired many successors. Much of our knowledge of rural change depends on these studies.

1. Efforts need to be made to raise farm and non-farm rural real incomes.
2. Investment in basic infra-structure and social services need to be increased.
3. Coordinated and integrated programmes for solving the present problems and to achieve sustainable development need to be designed.
4. Persons and leaders with an understanding of reality of rural problems and with the required foresight vision should be consulted while designing development programmes.

10.13 Conclusion

Crucial steps to strengthening the rural economy are already being taken through various policies. These steps include investments in areas ranging from health, information technology, education, infrastructure and small business. The Administration is committed to building on these unprecedented measures in the months and years to come. PURA (Provision of Urban facilities for Rural Areas) needs to be given due emphasis, without which Indian villages cannot prosper.

Glossary

Rural Economics	Application of Economic Principles in rural areas.
Population Density	Number of persons living per sq.km or per sq. mile.
Unemployment	Situation of people with willingness and ability to work but not getting employed.

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